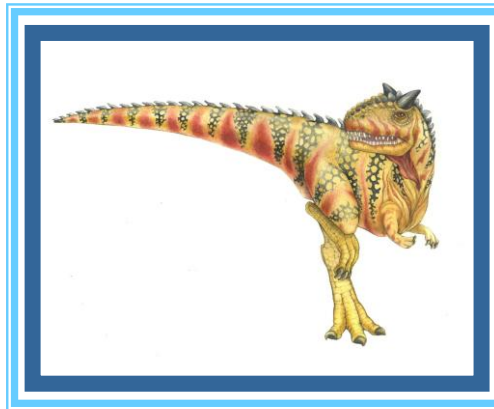
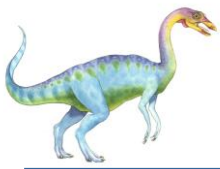


Chapter 1: Introduction

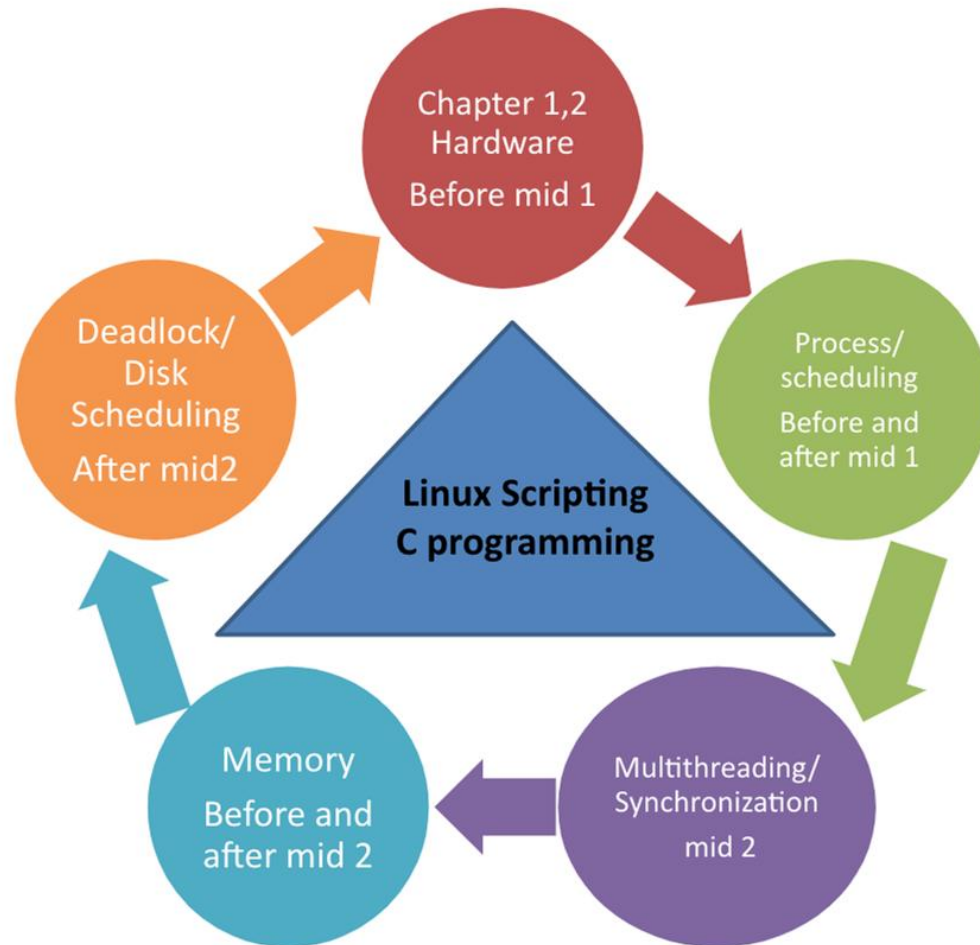
Operating Systems (CS-2006) Spring 2026

COURSE SUPERVISOR: ANAUM HAMID





Course Outline

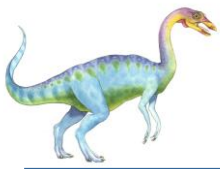




Evaluation Instruments and Marks Distributions

- Project = 10 marks
- Quiz/Assignment = 10 Marks
- Midterm = 30 marks (15 for each)
- Final Term = 50 marks
- Total = 100 Marks





Course Resources

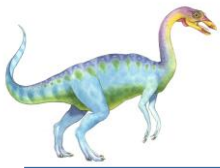
- **TEXTBOOK:**

- Operating Systems Concepts, 10th Edition, by Abraham Silberschatz, Peter Baer Galvin, and Greg Gagne.

- **REFERENCE BOOKS:**

- Operating Systems—Internals and Design Principles, 9th edition, by William Stallings.

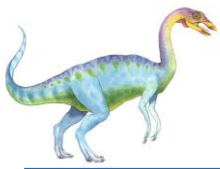




Chapter 1: Introduction

- What Operating Systems Do
- Computer-System Organization
- Computer-System Architecture
- Operating-System Operations
- **Kernel Data Structures**
- **Computing Environments**
- **Free/Libre and Open-Source Operating Systems**

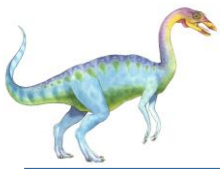




What is an Operating System?

- **Operating system (OS):** a **system software** that exploits the **hardware resources** to provide a set of services to system users.
- The OS manages the processor(s), memory and input/output (I/O) devices on behalf of its users.
- **Note:** it is important to have some fundamental understanding of basic data structures, computer organization and a high-level programming language, such as C or Java, before examining topics related to operating systems.

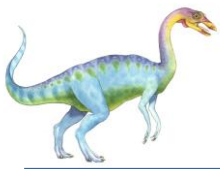




What is an Operating System?

- A program that acts as an intermediary between a user of a computer and the computer hardware
- Operating system goals:
 - Execute user programs and make solving user problems easier
 - Make the computer system convenient to use
 - Use the computer hardware in an efficient manner

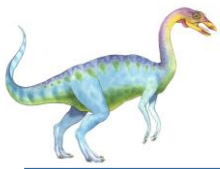




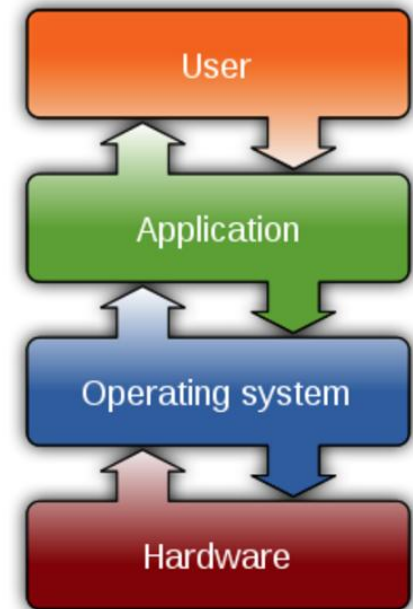
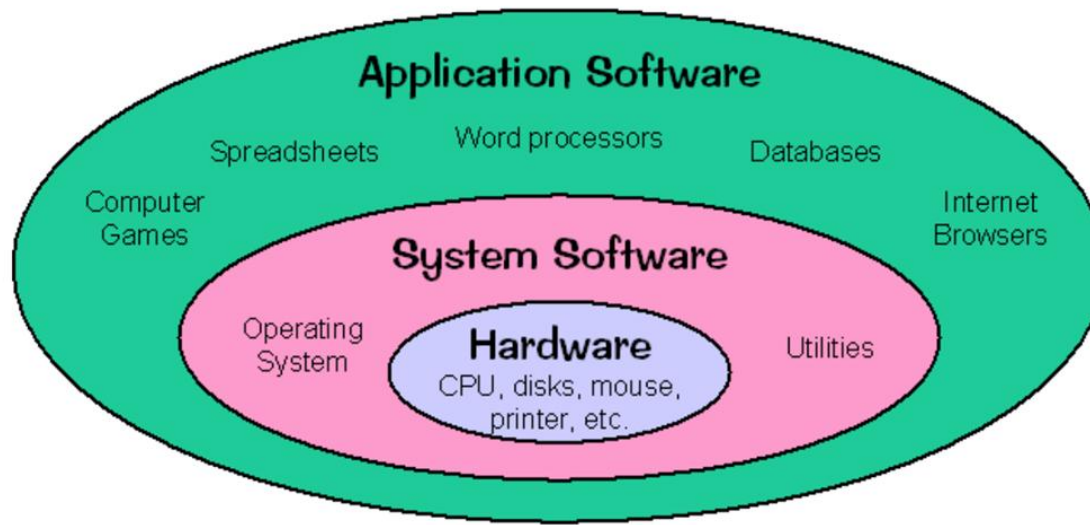
Computer System Structure

- Computer system can be divided into four components:
 - Hardware – provides basic computing resources
 - 4 CPU, memory, I/O devices
 - Operating system
 - 4 Controls and coordinates use of hardware among various applications and users
 - Application programs – define the ways in which the system resources are used to solve the computing problems of the users
 - 4 Word processors, compilers, web browsers, database systems, video games
 - Users
 - 4 People, machines, other computers





Computer System Structure

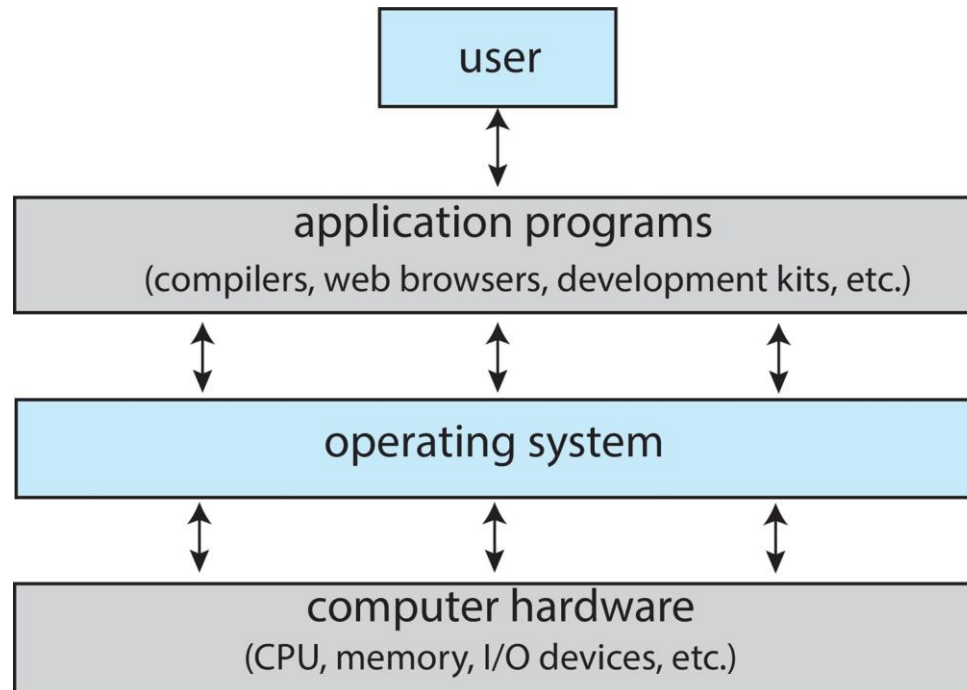


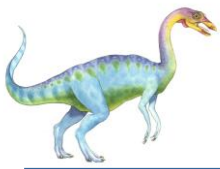
Relationship between application software and system software





Abstract View of Components of Computer

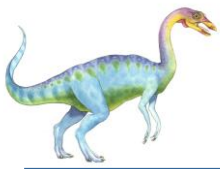




What Operating Systems Do

- Users want convenience, **ease of use** and **good performance**
 - Don't care about **resource utilization**
- But shared computer such as **mainframe** or **minicomputer** must keep all users happy
 - Operating system is a **resource allocator** and **control program** making efficient use of HW and managing execution of user programs
- Users of dedicate systems such as **workstations** have dedicated resources but frequently use shared resources from **servers**
- Mobile devices like smartphones and tables are resource poor, optimized for usability and battery life
 - Mobile user interfaces such as touch screens, voice recognition
- Some computers have little or no user interface, such as embedded computers in devices and automobiles
 - Run primarily without user intervention

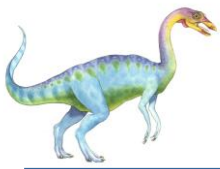




Defining Operating Systems

- Term OS covers many roles
 - OS is a resource allocator
 - Manages all resources
 - Decides between conflicting requests for efficient and fair resource use
 - OS is a control program
 - Controls execution of programs to prevent errors and improper use of the computer

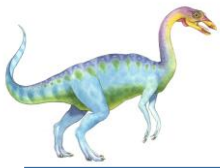




Operating System Definition

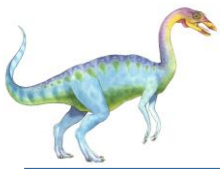
- “The one program running at all times on the computer” is the **kernel**, part of the operating system
- Everything else is either
 - A **system program** (ships with the operating system, but not part of the kernel) , or
 - An **application program**, all programs not associated with the operating system
- Today’s OSeS for general purpose and mobile computing also include **middleware** – a set of software frameworks that provide additional services to application developers such as databases, multimedia, graphics





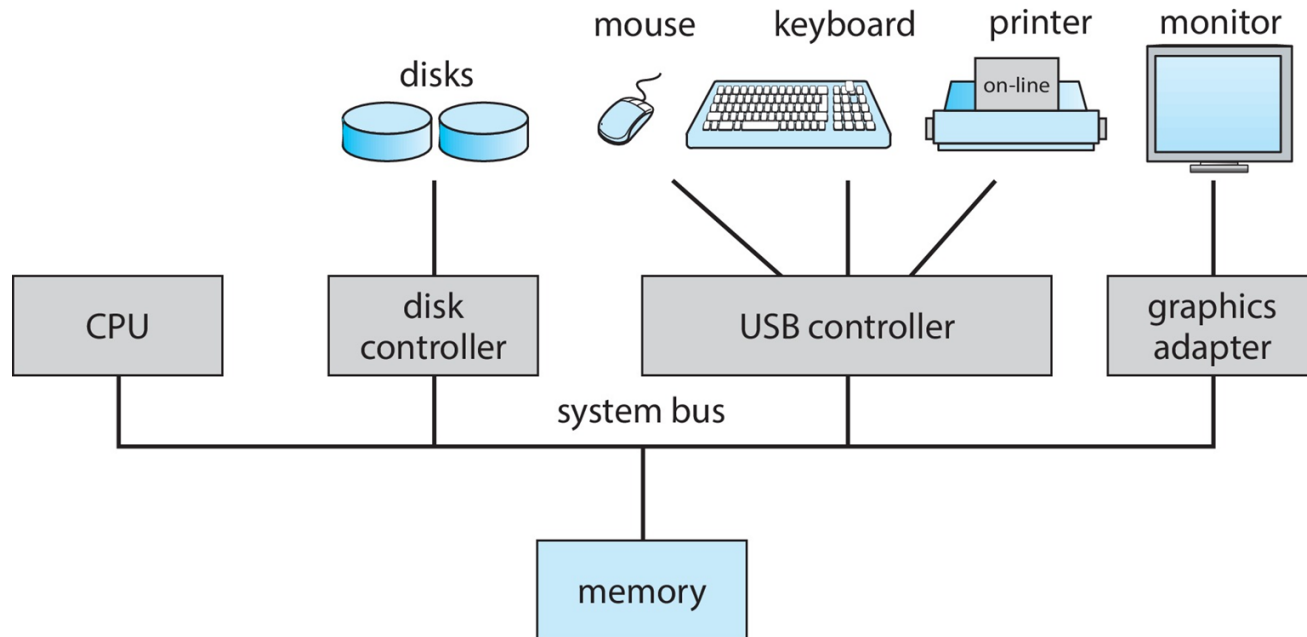
Overview of Computer System Structure

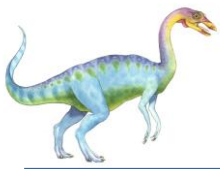




Computer System Organization

- Computer-system operation
 - One or more CPUs, device controllers connect through common **bus** providing access to shared memory
 - Concurrent execution of CPUs and devices competing for memory cycles

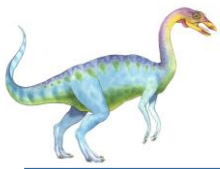




Computer-System Operation

- I/O devices and the CPU can execute concurrently
- Each device controller is in charge of a particular device type
- Each device controller has a local buffer
- Each device controller type has an operating system **device driver** to manage it
- CPU moves data from/to main memory to/from local buffers
- I/O is from the device to local buffer of controller
- Device controller informs CPU that it has finished its operation by causing an **interrupt**

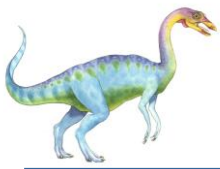




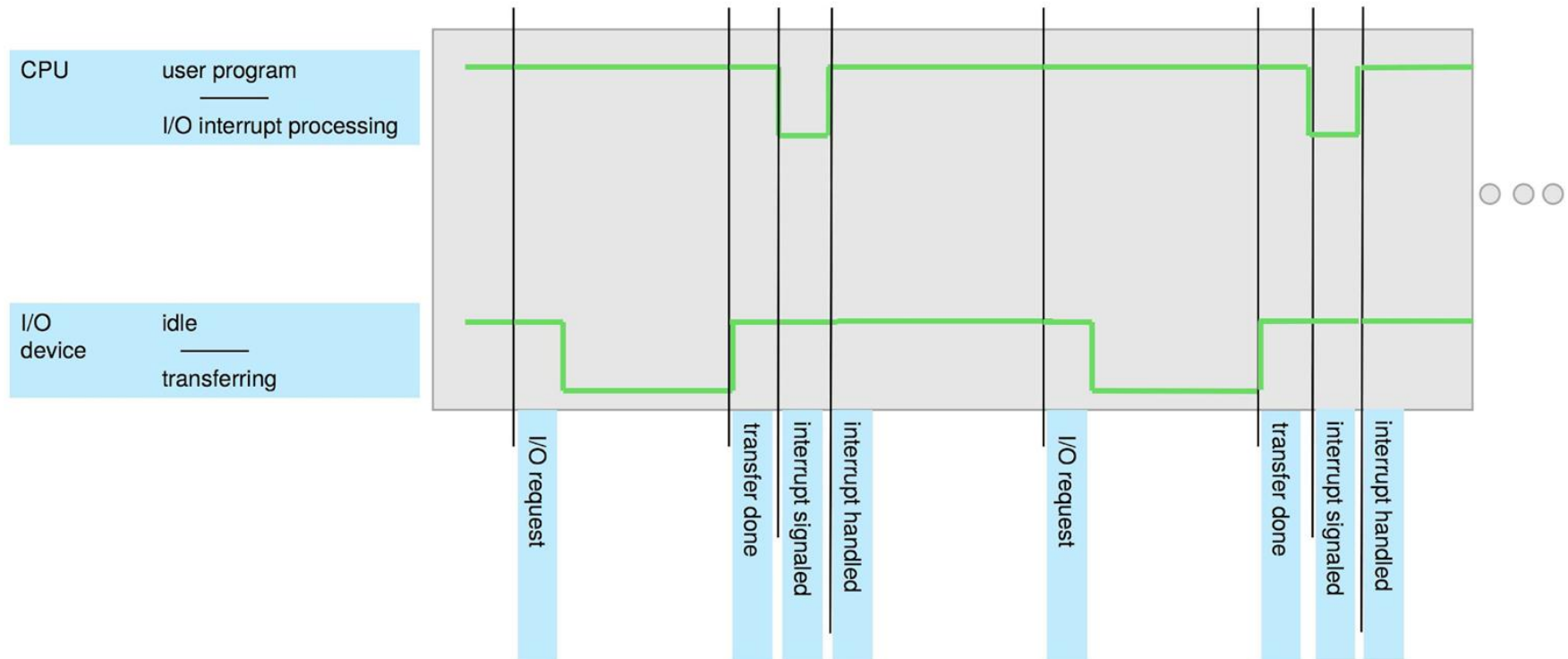
Common Functions of Interrupts

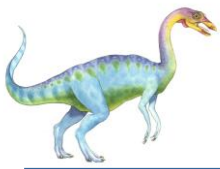
- Interrupt transfers control to the interrupt service routine generally, through the **interrupt vector**, which contains the addresses of all the service routines
- Interrupt architecture must save the address of the interrupted instruction
- A **trap** or **exception** is a software-generated interrupt caused either by an error or a user request
- An operating system is **interrupt driven**





Interrupt Timeline

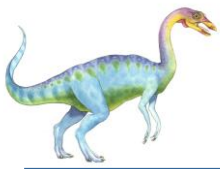




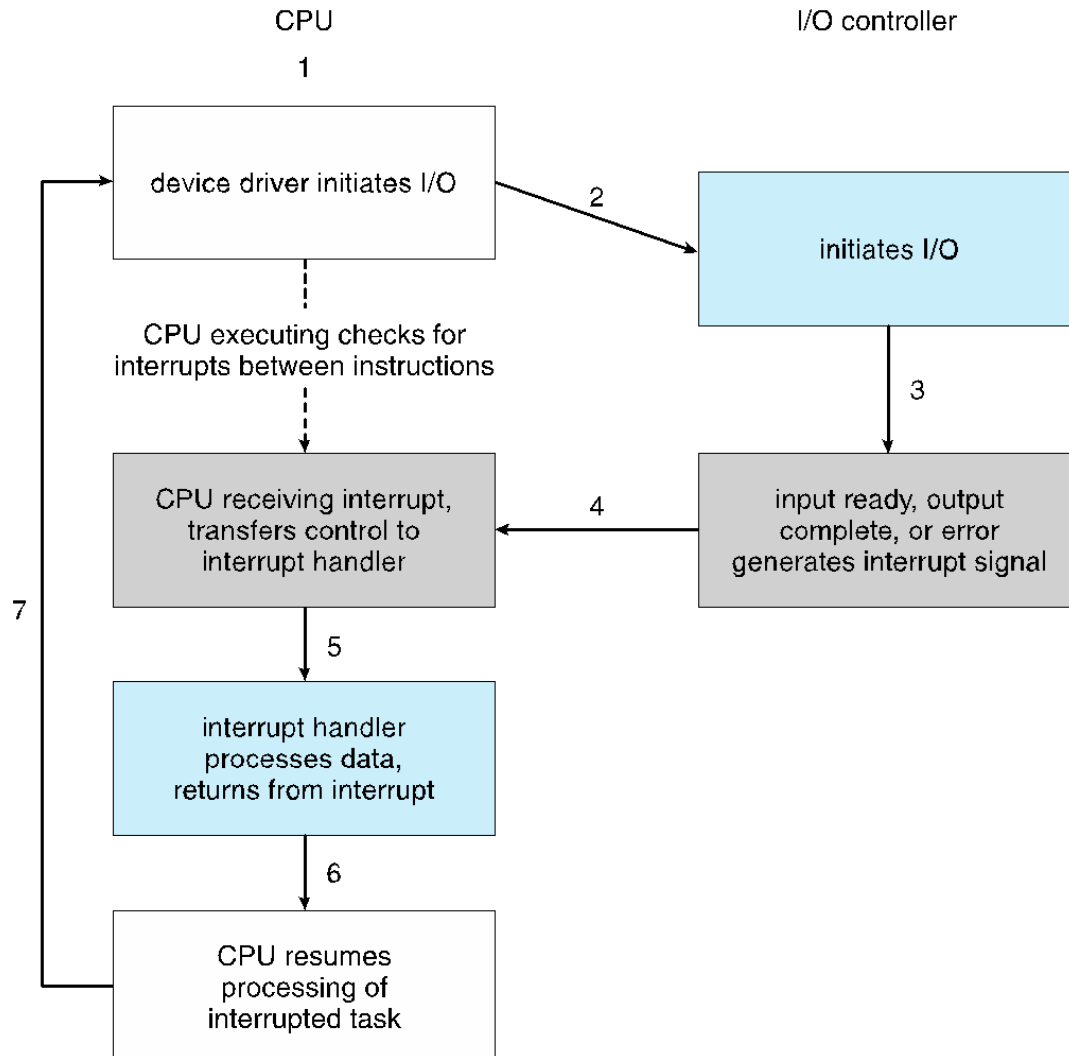
Interrupt Handling

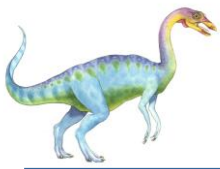
- The operating system preserves the state of the CPU by storing the registers and the program counter
- Determines which type of interrupt has occurred:
- Separate segments of code determine what action should be taken for each type of interrupt





Interrupt-drive I/O Cycle

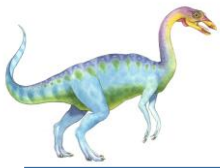




I/O Structure

- Two methods for handling I/O
 - After I/O starts, control returns to user program only upon I/O completion
 - After I/O starts, control returns to user program without waiting for I/O completion





I/O Structure (Cont.)

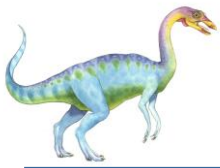
- After I/O starts, control returns to user program only upon I/O completion
 - Wait instruction idles the CPU until the next interrupt
 - Wait loop (contention for memory access)
 - At most one I/O request is outstanding at a time, no simultaneous I/O processing
- After I/O starts, control returns to user program without waiting for I/O completion
 - **System call** – request to the OS to allow user to wait for I/O completion
 - **Device-status table** contains entry for each I/O device indicating its type, address, and state
 - OS indexes into I/O device table to determine device status and to modify table entry to include interrupt





Storage Structure

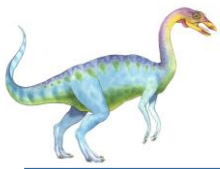




Storage Structure

- Main memory – only large storage media that the CPU can access directly
 - **Random access**
 - Typically **volatile**
 - Typically **random-access memory** in the form of **Dynamic Random-access Memory (DRAM)**
- Secondary storage – extension of main memory that provides large **nonvolatile** storage capacity





Storage Structure (Cont.)

- **Hard Disk Drives (HDD)** – rigid metal or glass platters covered with magnetic recording material
 - Disk surface is logically divided into **tracks**, which are subdivided into **sectors**
 - The **disk controller** determines the logical interaction between the device and the computer
- **Non-volatile memory (NVM)** devices– faster than hard disks, nonvolatile
 - Various technologies
 - Becoming more popular as capacity and performance increases, price drops





Storage Definitions and Notation Review

The basic unit of computer storage is the **bit**. A bit can contain one of two values, 0 and 1. All other storage in a computer is based on collections of bits. Given enough bits, it is amazing how many things a computer can represent: numbers, letters, images, movies, sounds, documents, and programs, to name a few. A **byte** is 8 bits, and on most computers it is the smallest convenient chunk of storage. For example, most computers don't have an instruction to move a bit but do have one to move a byte. A less common term is **word**, which is a given computer architecture's native unit of data. A word is made up of one or more bytes. For example, a computer that has 64-bit registers and 64-bit memory addressing typically has 64-bit (8-byte) words. A computer executes many operations in its native word size rather than a byte at a time.

Computer storage, along with most computer throughput, is generally measured and manipulated in bytes and collections of bytes. A **kilobyte**, or KB, is 1,024 bytes; a **megabyte**, or MB, is $1,024^2$ bytes; a **gigabyte**, or GB, is $1,024^3$ bytes; a **terabyte**, or TB, is $1,024^4$ bytes; and a **petabyte**, or PB, is $1,024^5$ bytes. Computer manufacturers often round off these numbers and say that a megabyte is 1 million bytes and a gigabyte is 1 billion bytes. Networking measurements are an exception to this general rule; they are given in bits (because networks move data a bit at a time).

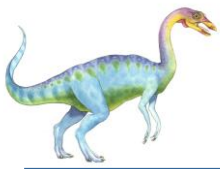




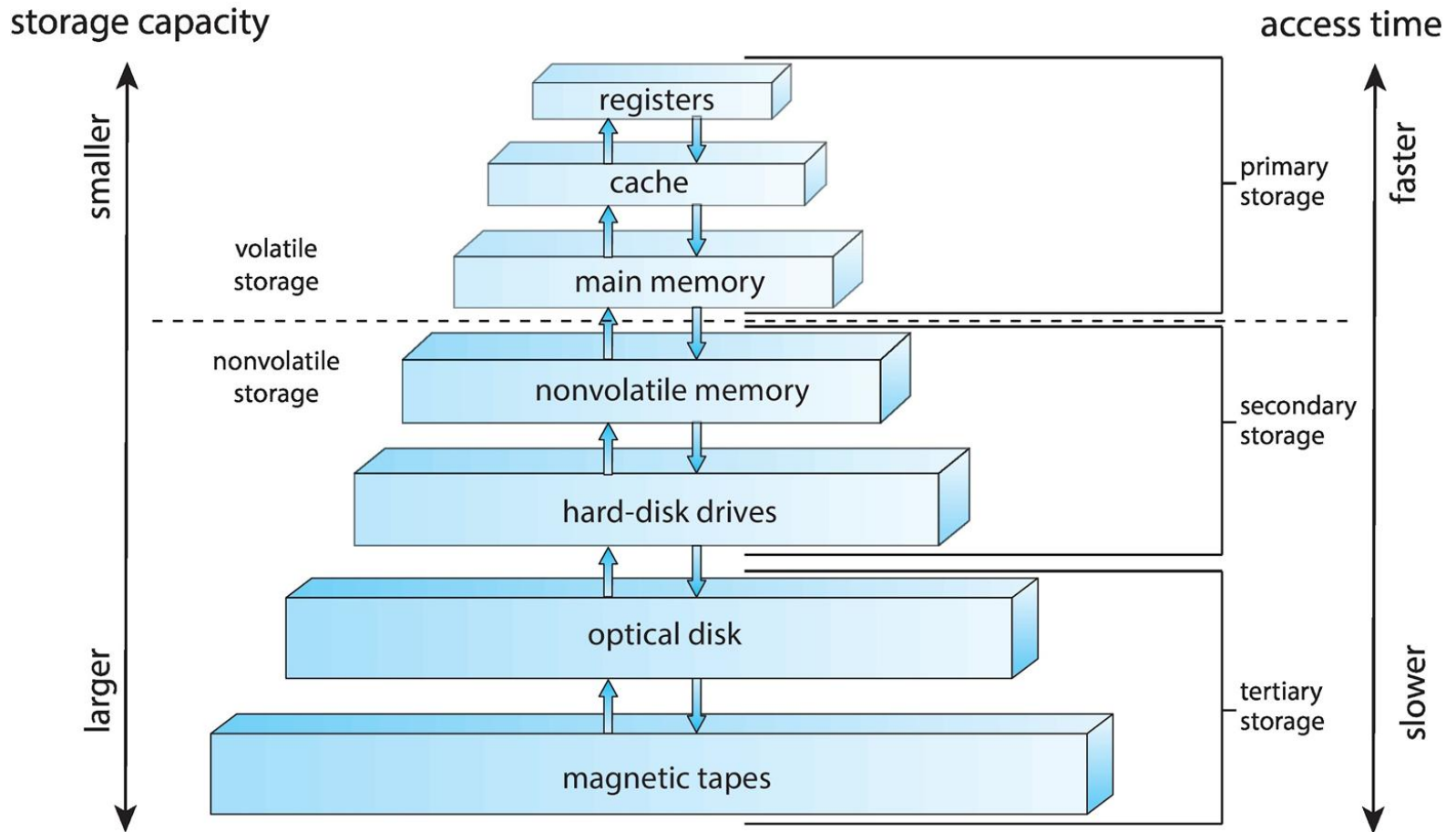
Storage Hierarchy

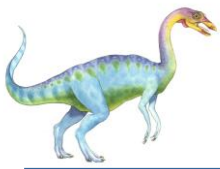
- Storage systems organized in hierarchy
 - Speed
 - Cost
 - Volatility
- **Caching** – copying information into faster storage system; main memory can be viewed as a cache for secondary storage
- **Device Driver** for each device controller to manage I/O
 - Provides uniform interface between controller and kernel



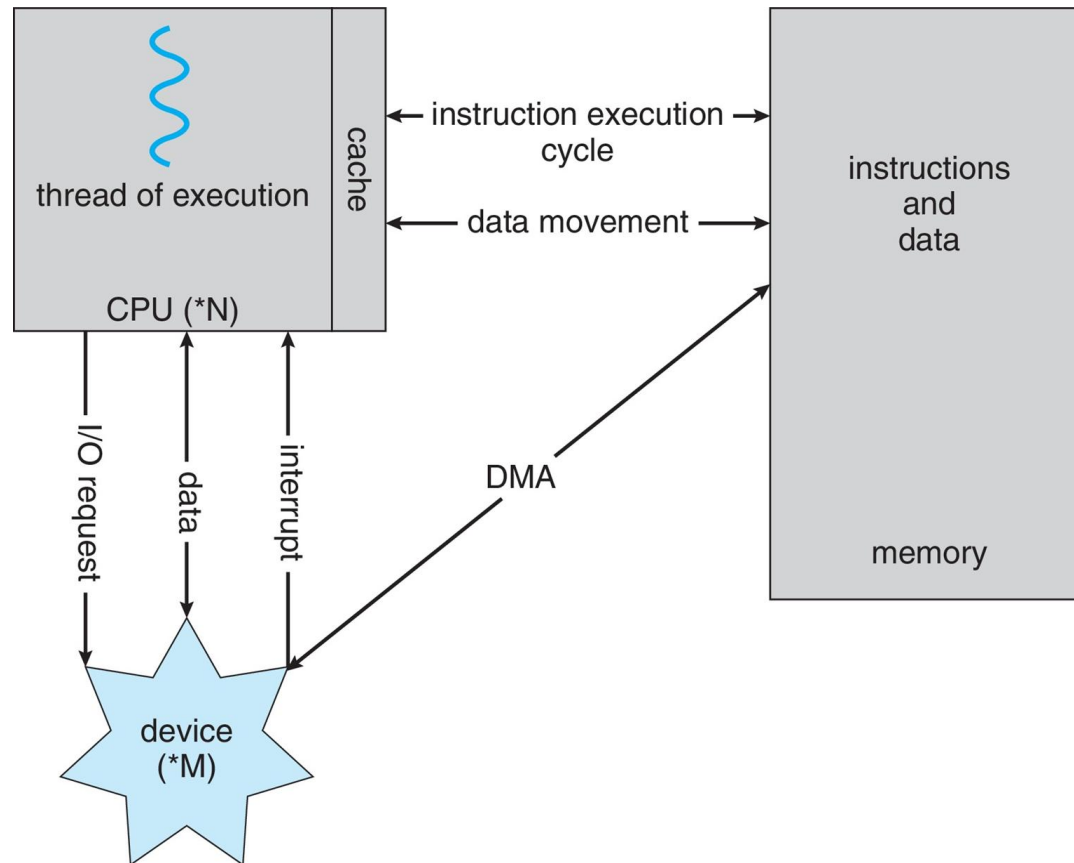


Storage-Device Hierarchy



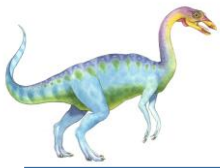


How a Modern Computer Works



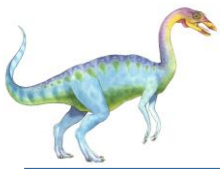
A von Neumann architecture





Computer System Architecture

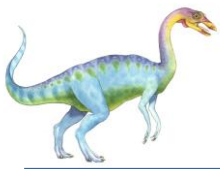




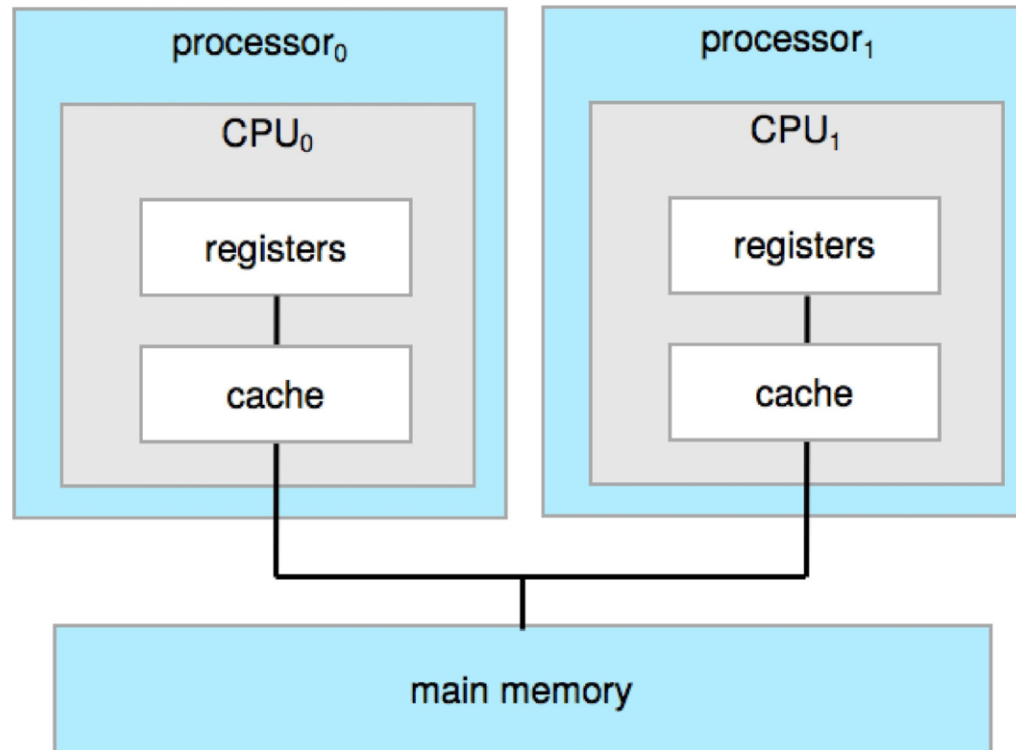
Computer-System Architecture

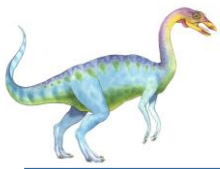
- Most systems use a single general-purpose processor
 - Most systems have special-purpose processors as well
- **Multiprocessors** systems growing in use and importance
 - Also known as **parallel systems**, **tightly-coupled systems**
 - Advantages include:
 1. **Increased throughput**
 2. **Economy of scale**
 3. **Increased reliability** – graceful degradation or fault tolerance
 - Two types:
 1. **Asymmetric Multiprocessing** – each processor is assigned a specific task.
 2. **Symmetric Multiprocessing** – each processor performs all tasks





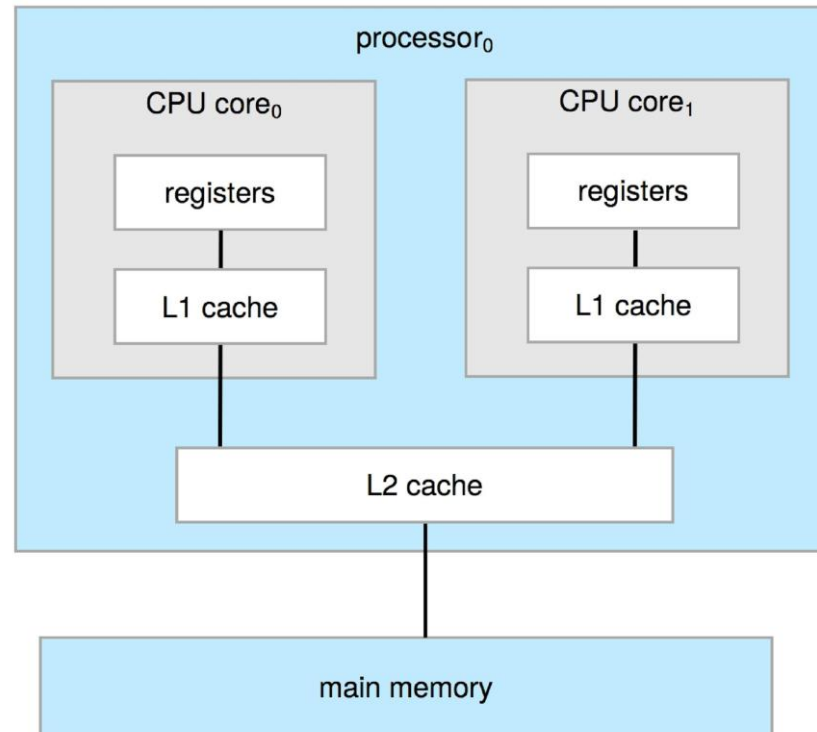
Symmetric Multiprocessing Architecture

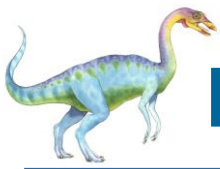




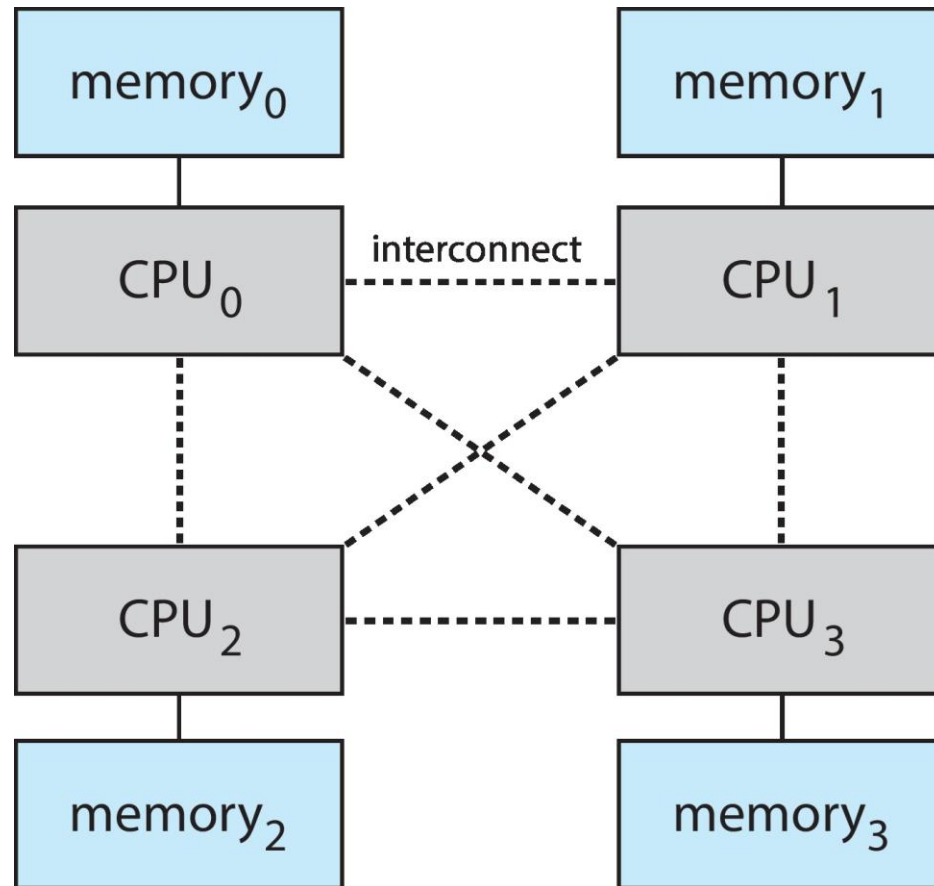
Dual-Core Design

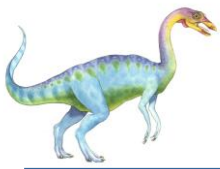
- Multi-chip and **multicore**
- Systems containing all chips
 - Chassis containing multiple separate systems





Non-Uniform Memory Access System

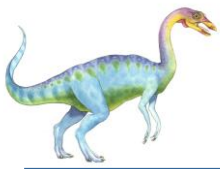




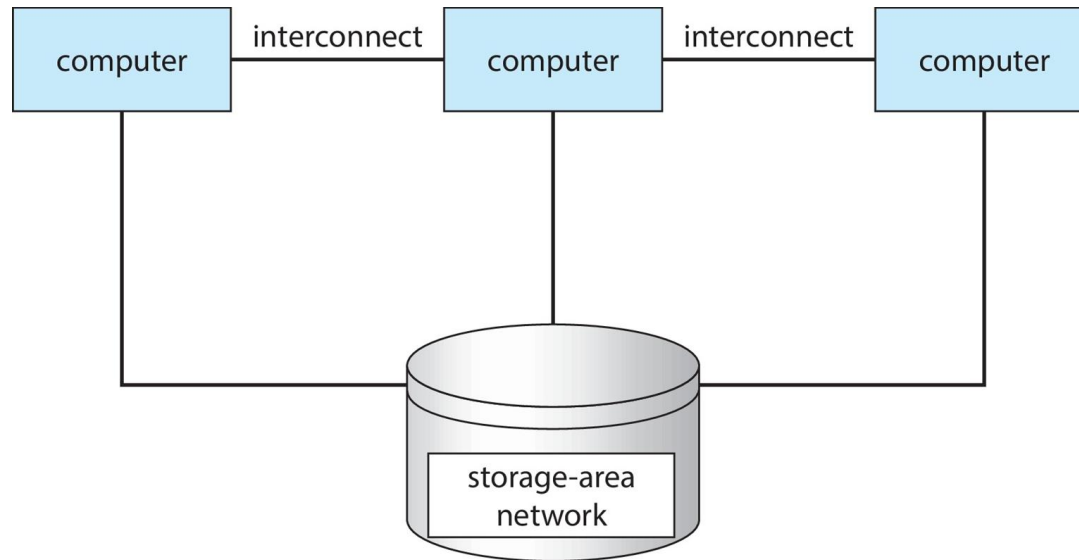
Clustered Systems

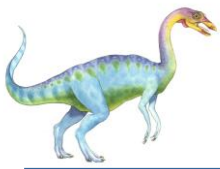
- Like multiprocessor systems, but multiple systems working together
 - Usually sharing storage via a **storage-area network (SAN)**
 - Provides a **high-availability** service which survives failures
 - 4 **Asymmetric clustering** has one machine in hot-standby mode
 - 4 **Symmetric clustering** has multiple nodes running applications, monitoring each other
 - Some clusters are for **high-performance computing (HPC)**
 - 4 Applications must be written to use **parallelization**
 - Some have **distributed lock manager (DLM)** to avoid conflicting operations





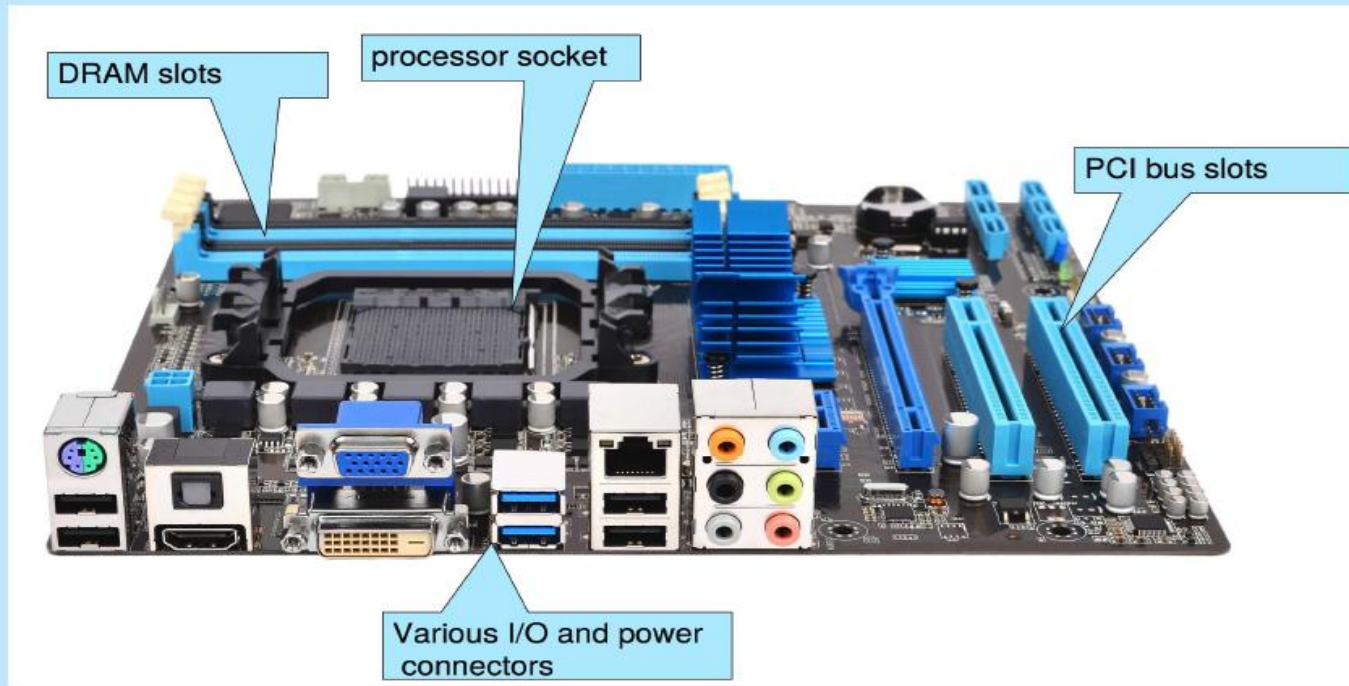
Clustered Systems





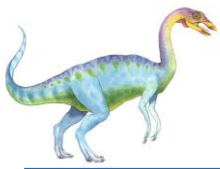
PC Motherboard

Consider the desktop PC motherboard with a processor socket shown below:



This board is a fully-functioning computer, once its slots are populated. It consists of a processor socket containing a CPU, DRAM sockets, PCIe bus slots, and I/O connectors of various types. Even the lowest-cost general-purpose CPU contains multiple cores. Some motherboards contain multiple processor sockets. More advanced computers allow more than one system board, creating NUMA systems.

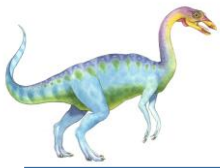




Direct Memory Access Structure

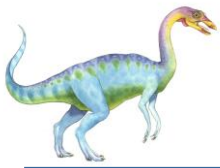
- Used for high-speed I/O devices able to transmit information at close to memory speeds
- Device controller transfers blocks of data from buffer storage directly to main memory without CPU intervention
- Only one interrupt is generated per block, rather than the one interrupt per byte





Operating-System Operations

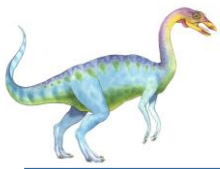




Operating-System Operations

- Bootstrap program – simple code to initialize the system, load the kernel
- Kernel loads
- Starts **system daemons** (services provided outside of the kernel)
- Kernel **interrupt driven** (hardware and software)
 - Hardware interrupt by one of the devices
 - Software interrupt (**exception** or **trap**):
 - 4 Software error (e.g., division by zero)
 - 4 Request for operating system service – **system call**
 - 4 Other process problems include infinite loop, processes modifying each other or the operating system

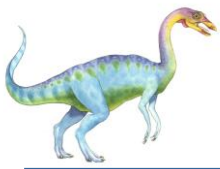




Multiprogramming (Batch system)

- Single user cannot always keep CPU and I/O devices busy
- Multiprogramming organizes jobs (code and data) so CPU always has one to execute
- A subset of total jobs in system is kept in memory
- One job selected and run via **job scheduling**
- When job has to wait (for I/O for example), OS switches to another job

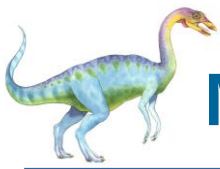




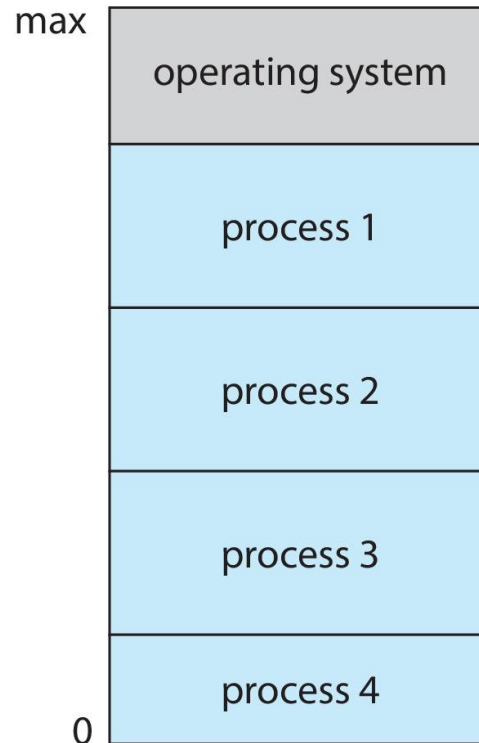
Multitasking (Timesharing)

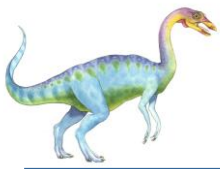
- A logical extension of Batch systems– the CPU switches jobs so frequently that users can interact with each job while it is running, creating **interactive** computing
 - **Response time** should be < 1 second
 - Each user has at least one program executing in memory
? **process**
 - If several jobs ready to run at the same time ? **CPU scheduling**
 - If processes don't fit in memory, **swapping** moves them in and out to run
 - **Virtual memory** allows execution of processes not completely in memory





Memory Layout for Multiprogrammed System

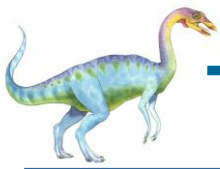




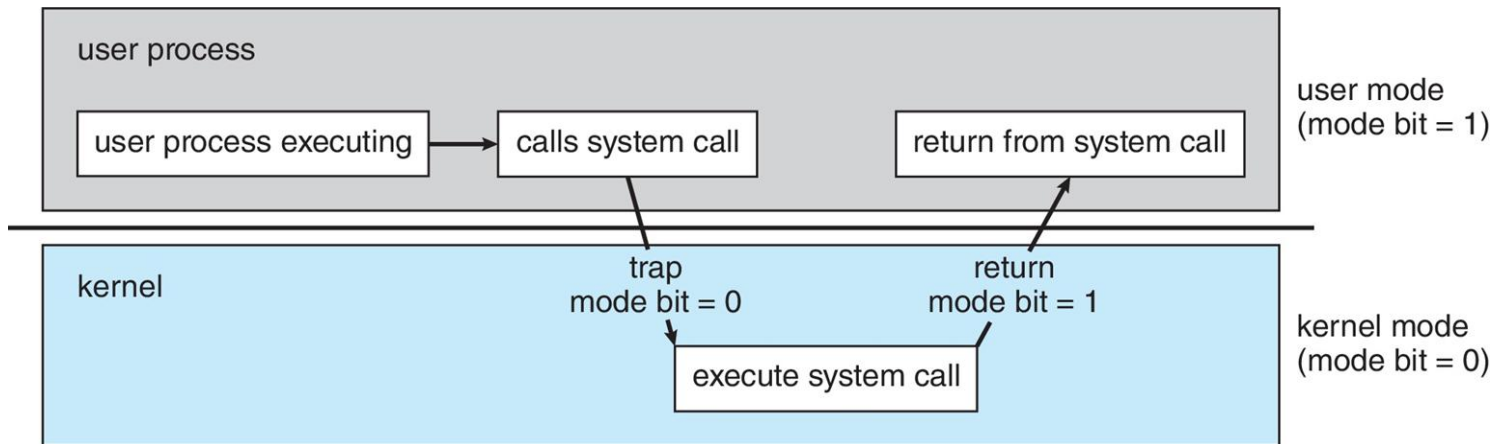
Dual-mode Operation

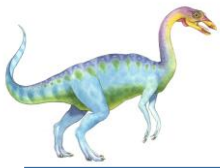
- **Dual-mode** operation allows OS to protect itself and other system components
 - **User mode** and **kernel mode**
- **Mode bit** provided by hardware
 - Provides ability to distinguish when system is running user code or kernel code.
 - When a user is running ☐ mode bit is “user”
 - When kernel code is executing ☐ mode bit is “kernel”
- How do we guarantee that user does not explicitly set the mode bit to “kernel”?
 - System call changes mode to kernel, return from call resets it to user
- Some instructions designated as **privileged**, only executable in kernel mode





Transition from User to Kernel Mode

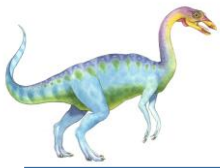




Timer

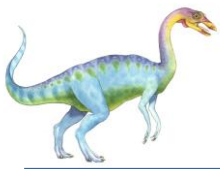
- Timer to prevent infinite loop (or process hogging resources)
 - Timer is set to interrupt the computer after some time period
 - Keep a counter that is decremented by the physical clock
 - Operating system set the counter (privileged instruction)
 - When counter zero generate an interrupt
 - Set up before scheduling process to regain control or terminate program that exceeds allotted time





Kernel Data Structure



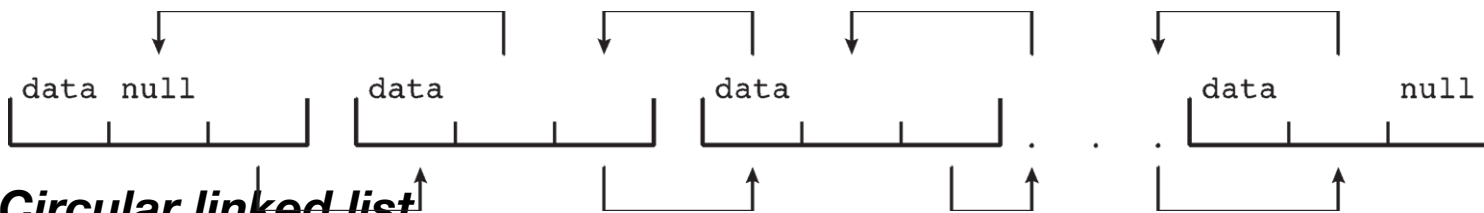


Kernel Data Structures

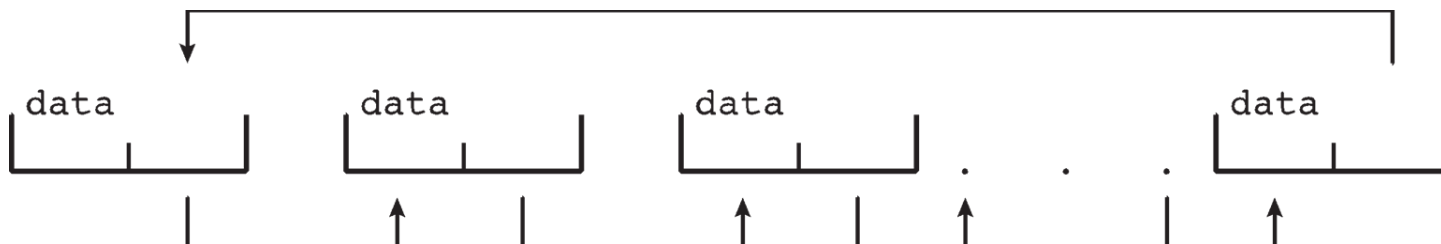
- Many similar to standard programming data structures
- Singly linked list***

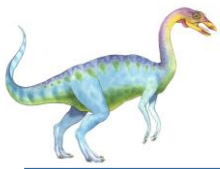


- Doubly linked list***



- Circular linked list***



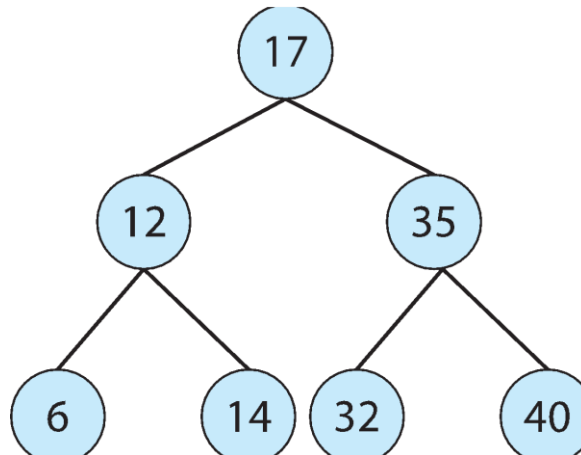


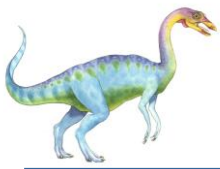
Kernel Data Structures

- **Binary search tree**

left $\leq$ right

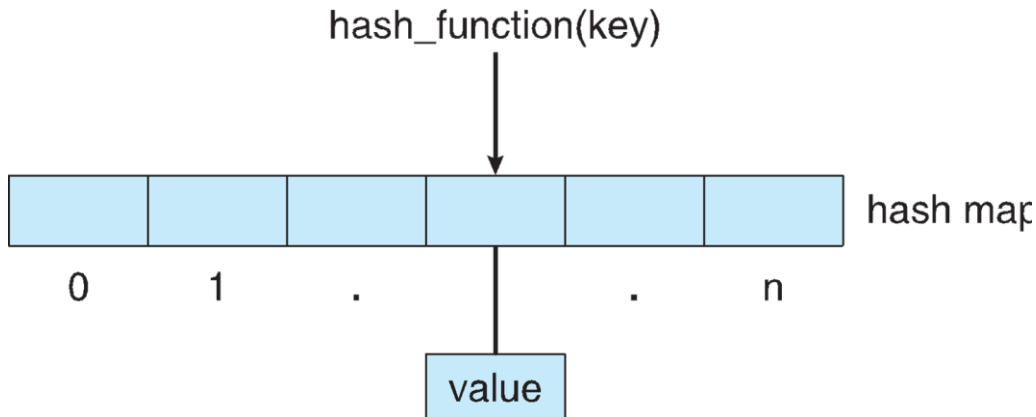
- Search performance is $O(n)$
- **Balanced binary search tree** is $O(\lg n)$





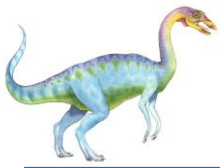
Kernel Data Structures

- **Hash function** can create a **hash map**



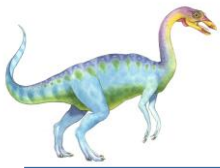
- **Bitmap** – string of n binary digits representing the status of n items
- Linux data structures defined in **include** files `<linux/list.h>`, `<linux/kfifo.h>`, `<linux/rbtree.h>`





Computer System Environments

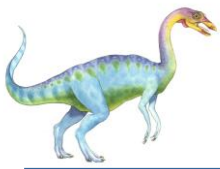




Computing Environments

- Traditional
- Mobile
- Client Server
- Peer-to-Peer
- Cloud computing
- Real-time Embedded

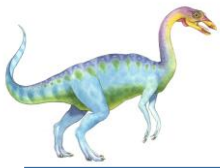




Traditional

- Stand-alone general-purpose machines
- But blurred as most systems interconnect with others (i.e., the Internet)
- **Portals** provide web access to internal systems
- **Network computers (thin clients)** are like Web terminals
- Mobile computers interconnect via **wireless networks**
- Networking becoming ubiquitous – even home systems use **firewalls** to protect home computers from Internet attacks

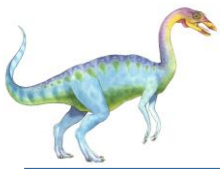




Mobile

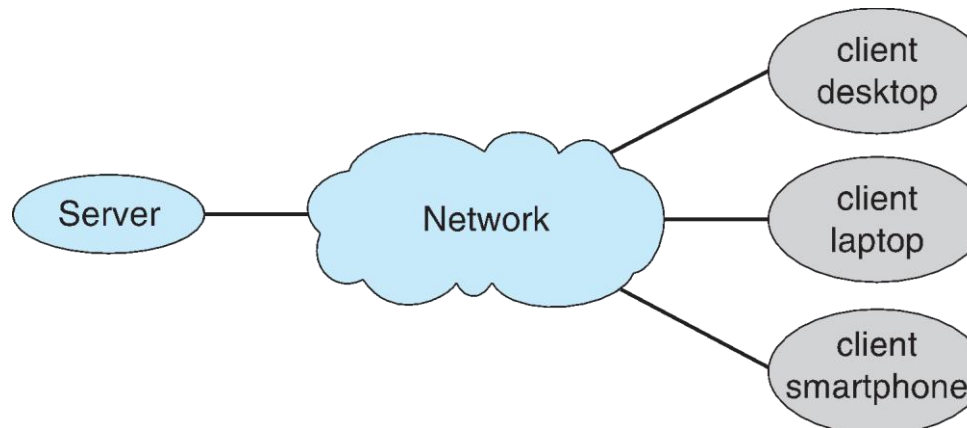
- Handheld smartphones, tablets, etc.
- What is the functional difference between them and a “traditional” laptop?
- Extra feature – more OS features (GPS, gyroscope)
- Allows new types of apps like ***augmented reality***
- Use IEEE 802.11 wireless, or cellular data networks for connectivity
- Leaders are **Apple iOS** and **Google Android**

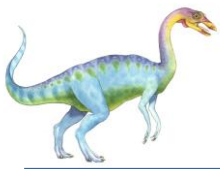




Client Server

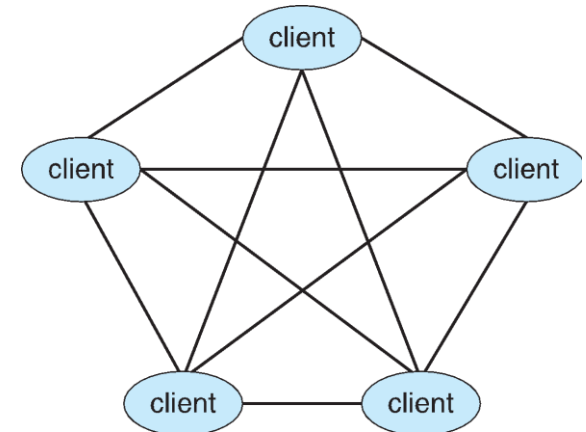
- Client-Server Computing
 - Dumb terminals supplanted by smart PCs
 - Many systems now **servers**, responding to requests generated by **clients**
 - 4 **Compute-server system** provides an interface to client to request services (i.e., database)
 - 4 **File-server system** provides interface for clients to store and retrieve files

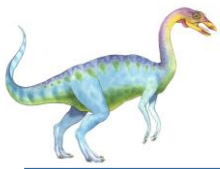




Peer-to-Peer

- Another model of distributed system
- P2P does not distinguish clients and servers
 - Instead all nodes are considered peers
 - May each act as client, server or both
 - Node must join P2P network
 - 4 Registers its service with central lookup service on network, or
 - 4 Broadcast request for service and respond to requests for service via ***discovery protocol***
 - Examples include Napster and Gnutella, **Voice over IP (VoIP)** such as Skype

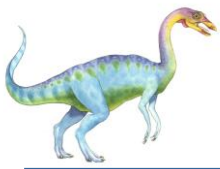




Cloud Computing

- Delivers computing, storage, even apps as a service across a network
- Logical extension of virtualization because it uses virtualization as the base for its functionality.
 - Amazon **EC2** has thousands of servers, millions of virtual machines, petabytes of storage available across the Internet, pay based on usage

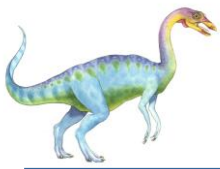




Cloud Computing (Cont.)

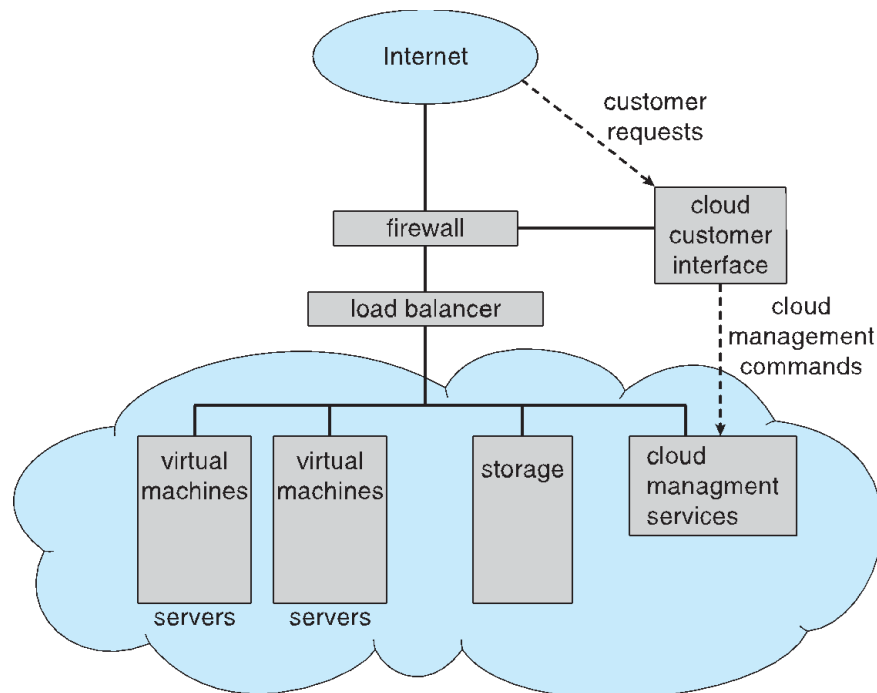
- Many types
 - **Public cloud** – available via Internet to anyone willing to pay
 - **Private cloud** – run by a company for the company's own use
 - **Hybrid cloud** – includes both public and private cloud components
 - Software as a Service (**SaaS**) – one or more applications available via the Internet (i.e., word processor)
 - Platform as a Service (**PaaS**) – software stack ready for application use via the Internet (i.e., a database server)
 - Infrastructure as a Service (**IaaS**) – servers or storage available over Internet (i.e., storage available for backup use)

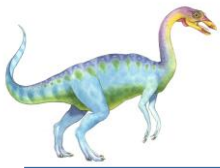




Cloud Computing (cont.)

- Cloud computing environments composed of traditional OSeS, plus VMMs, plus cloud management tools
 - Internet connectivity requires security like firewalls
 - Load balancers spread traffic across multiple applications

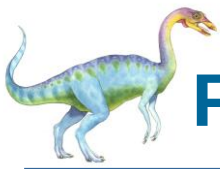




Real-Time Embedded Systems

- Real-time embedded systems most prevalent form of computers
 - Vary considerable, special purpose, limited purpose OS, **real-time OS**
 - Use expanding
- Many other special computing environments as well
 - Some have OSes, some perform tasks without an OS
- Real-time OS has well-defined fixed time constraints
 - Processing **must** be done within constraint
 - Correct operation only if constraints met

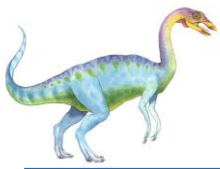




Free and Open-Source Operating Systems

- Operating systems made available in source-code format rather than just binary **closed-source** and **proprietary**
- Counter to the **copy protection** and **Digital Rights Management (DRM)** movement
- Started by **Free Software Foundation (FSF)**, which has “copyleft” **GNU Public License (GPL)**
 - Free software and open-source software are two different ideas championed by different groups of people
 - 4 <https://www.gnu.org/philosophy/open-source-misses-the-point.en.html>
- Examples include **GNU/Linux** and **BSD UNIX** (including core of **Mac OS X**), and many more
- Can use VMM like VMware Player (Free on Windows), Virtualbox (open source and free on many platforms - <http://www.virtualbox.com>)
 - Use to run guest operating systems for exploration





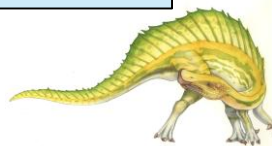
The Study of Operating Systems

There has never been a more interesting time to study operating systems, and it has never been easier. The open-source movement has overtaken operating systems, causing many of them to be made available in both source and binary (executable) format. The list of operating systems available in both formats includes Linux, BSD UNIX, Solaris, and part of macOS. The availability of source code allows us to study operating systems from the inside out. Questions that we could once answer only by looking at documentation or the behavior of an operating system we can now answer by examining the code itself.

Operating systems that are no longer commercially viable have been open-sourced as well, enabling us to study how systems operated in a time of fewer CPU, memory, and storage resources. An extensive but incomplete list of open-source operating-system projects is available from https://curlie.org/Computers/Software/Operating_Systems/Open_Source/

In addition, the rise of virtualization as a mainstream (and frequently free) computer function makes it possible to run many operating systems on top of one core system. For example, VMware (<http://www.vmware.com>) provides a free “player” for Windows on which hundreds of free “virtual appliances” can run. Virtualbox (<http://www.virtualbox.com>) provides a free, open-source virtual machine manager on many operating systems. Using such tools, students can try out hundreds of operating systems without dedicated hardware.

The advent of open-source operating systems has also made it easier to make the move from student to operating-system developer. With some knowledge, some effort, and an Internet connection, a student can even create a new operating-system distribution. Just a few years ago, it was difficult or impossible to get access to source code. Now, such access is limited only by how much interest, time, and disk space a student has.



End of Chapter 1

